

Validation passes per manifest

1. File exists at canonical path (helix-deps.yaml preferred; .json / .toml accepted)
2. schema_version: 1 declared
3. deps: top-level array present
4. transitive_handling: block present

(Deeper schema validation — per-dep name/ssh_url/ref/why/layout field-level checks — is owed to a follow-up enhancement; current scanner uses a structural grep-based fallback that catches the most common drift class without requiring yq / python-yaml toolchain.)

Modes

Flag	Behavior
--strict (default)	Exit 1 on any violation
--advisory	Exit 0 even on violation
LAVA_HELIX_DEPS_STRICT=0 env	Same as --advisory

Usage

```
bash scripts/check-helix-deps-manifest.sh           # strict
              (default)
bash scripts/check-helix-deps-manifest.sh --advisory # exit 0
              even on violation
LAVA_HELIX_DEPS_STRICT=0 bash scripts/check-helix-deps-
manifest.sh    # env-driven
```

Hermetic test

tests/check-constitution/test_helix_deps_manifest.sh — 6 fixtures:

1. test_compliant_fixture_passes — parent + per-submodule manifests both present + well-formed
2. test_missing_parent_manifest_rejected — repo root lacks helix-deps.yaml
3. test_missing_submodule_manifest_rejected — owned submodule lacks helix-deps.yaml
4. test_wrong_schema_version_rejected — schema_version: 999 (must be 1)
5. test_advisory_mode_returns_zero — advisory swallows exit code

6. `test_json_variant_accepted` — discrimination test: `helix-deps.json` is recognized as a valid alternative extension

Known violations (2026-05-15 audit)

Parent manifest:  `helix-deps.yaml` (well-formed, declares 17 deps: 16 vasic-digital submodules + constitution).

Per-submodule manifests: 16 of 16 owned submodules MISSING `helix-deps.yaml`.

Submodule	Status
Auth, Cache, Challenges, Concurrency, Config, Containers, Database, Discovery, HTTP3, Mdns, Middleware, Observability, RateLimiter, Recovery, Security, Tracker-SDK	× MISSING — owed in per-submodule follow-up commits

Resolution path: per-submodule cycle (write `helix-deps.yaml` → commit to submodule → push to GitHub + GitLab per §6.W → bump pin in parent Lava). The parent commit can batch the 16 pin bumps once each submodule has its own manifest. Then sweep wrapper flips from advisory → strict.

Cross-references

- HelixConstitution Constitution.md §11.4.31 (the mandate)
- docs/plans/2026-05-15-constitution-compliance.md Phase 3
- docs/helix-constitution-gates.md CM-HELIX-DEPS-MANIFEST row
- scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh (wraps this scanner per §11.4.32)
- Lava parent's reference manifest: `helix-deps.yaml` (declares all 16 submodule deps + constitution)

2026-05-15 update — HelixQA waiver

Phase 4 of the constitution-compliance plan adopted `submodules/helixqa` (HelixDevelopment-owned QA orchestration framework) at upstream HEAD 403603db. HelixQA's CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / CONSTITUTION.md follow the canonical-root ## INHERITED FROM Helix Constitution pointer pattern (HelixDevelopment-authored) rather than Lava's heading-anchored §6.R / §6.S / §6.X / §6.AD pointer-block format. HelixQA also lacks `helix-deps.yaml` + `install_upstreams.sh` wrapper script.

Resolution: `HELIX_DEV_OWNED=("HelixQA")` waiver list + `is_helix_dev_owned()` helper skip HelixQA in every per-Submodule loop in this scanner. Waiver entries cite Phase 4-debt: PR to HelixDevelopment/HelixQA upstream owed to add the missing files. Once upstream merges + Lava's pin advances to include them, HelixQA can be removed from the waiver list.

2026-05-16 update — HelixQA waiver RESOLVED

The Phase 4-debt PR to HelixDevelopment/HelixQA upstream landed as commit `b13ba7c (feat(gov): add helix-deps.yaml + install_upstreams.sh wrapper)`, adding both missing files at HelixQA's repo root. Lava's pin advanced to `b13ba7c` in the same parent commit that removed HelixQA from `HELIX_DEPS_WAIVERS`. The waiver list is now empty — the per-Submodule loop in this scanner treats HelixQA on equal terms with the other 16 owned submodules; all 17 must ship a parseable `helix-deps.yaml` at the submodule root or the scanner reports a violation. The `HELIX_DEPS_WAIVERS=()` empty array is intentionally retained as a forensic anchor.